The Opportunist

Level: Advanced

Prerequisites: #1 – Basic Strategy and #4 – Speculative Buy

In the basic strategy (PDF #1), we buy (or sell) at Open when there are standard Buy or Sell signals. The disadvantage is that we may get filled at a poor entry (or exit) price. The Opportunist is a way to solve that with tactically placed limit orders. This is a more active method that requires us to enter or adjust our limit buy or sell orders every day before the market opens.

After a regular Buy signal occurs it is quite common to see the price come down a bit in the following days. And then the upward move continues if all goes well. We can take advantage of that little pullback to get in at a better entry price. Let's look at some examples

Opportunistic Entry

Daily reversal levels as of the close on January 2, 2026

Name		Close	Tr	Mode	RevL (D)	MoM (D)	Days	P/L %	Action	R
Advanced Micro Devices	AMD	223.47	33		**211.64**	1.01 ▲	30	**+2.95%**	Buy	1.14 ▲ 23

QuickTarget Buy Limit: 221.10
Opportunist Buy Limit: 217.56

AMD is giving a Buy signal here. It closed at $223.47, but if we buy at Open we have no control over our entry price. Maybe it opens at $230. A limit order can solve that.

Hovering or tapping on the RevL we find the Opportunist Buy Limit at $217.56, so we can put in a limit buy order at that price or better. If we get filled we will be in this trade with a good entry price. If the price does not come down then we can update our limit buy order with the next Opportunist price tomorrow, and so on… The idea is to let the stock come to us. But there is no guarantee we will get our stock. Some stocks will not look back and we may have to abandon that buy candidate.

We can use the QuickTarget too. Here it is at $221.10. There is more chance that price will get a fill, but we would pay a bit more. The Opportunist price is more… opportunistic.

Now, let's say we tried to buy GOOGL using the Opportunist price and didn't get filled. How long can we continue "chasing" it? It depends on the price action.

Daily reversal levels as of the close on January 2, 2026

Name		Close	Tr	Mode	RevL (D)	MoM (D)	Days	P/L %	Action	R
Alphabet Inc	GOOGL	315.15	27		304.65	1.75 ▲	**8**	+1.70%		1.19▲ 19

Bullish since 22-Dec-2025
from 309.88

This is 8 days after the Buy signal and if we hover above "8" in the Days column we see the details. Buying at Open 8 days ago came with an entry at $309.88 and the trade shows a small profit. We can still try to get in with the Opportunist method:

Daily reversal levels as of the close on January 2, 2026

Name		Close	Tr	Mode	RevL (D)	MoM (D)	Days	P/L %	Action	R
Alphabet Inc	GOOGL	315.15	27		**304.65**	1.75 ▲	8	+1.70%		1.19▲ 19

QuickTarget Buy Limit: 313.05
Opportunist Buy Limit: 309.90

Hovering above the RevL we see the Opportunist price at $309.90 and the QuickTarget at $313.05. Both are still feasible for a limit order to buy on weakness. And your money would not have been at risk for those 8 days.

In other cases we will have to let a stock go, or wait for a bigger pullback. This is MU:

Daily reversal levels as of the close on January 2, 2026

Name		Close	Tr	Mode	RevL (D)	MoM (D)	Days	P/L %	Action	R
Micron Technology	MU	315.42	33		**256.97**	8.55 ▲	9	+25.29%	pP+	1.78▲ 27

QuickTarget Buy Limit: 303.73
Opportunist Buy Limit: 286.20

The stock is up 25% since its Buy signal 9 days ago. We can see it is unlikely for the Opportunist price to be filled today. But nobody stops you from trying. Usually it's better to use that capital for more realistic chances.

Sometimes second chances appear when a stock pauses after a good rally. Here is ADI:

Daily reversal levels as of the close on January 2, 2026

Name		Close	Tr	Mode	RevL (D)	MoM (D)	Days	P/L %	Action	R
Analog Devices Inc	ADI	273.74	5		**269.63**	-0.12 ▼	26	+18.71%		0.34 ▲ 3

QuickTarget Buy Limit: 272.92
Opportunist Buy Limit: 271.69

This stock is up 18% since a Buy signal 26 days ago. But it is retesting its RevL. With the stock in a fresh bullish trend (5 weeks) and R value positive it may have further to run. We also see MoM near zero and that's where it likes to turn back up after a pause or pullback.

The Opportunist and QuickTarget buy limit prices are not far away, making this a low risk re-entry point with the RevL at $269.63. In the worst case scenario it goes on to give a Sell signal, and that would usually be a small 1 or 2% loss to take. Limited downside, and undefined upside, that's what good risk/reward ratios are made of.

Opportunistic Exit

We can also use the Opportunist method for selling after a stock goes in bearish mode. But that comes with the risk of causing a bigger loss compared to just selling right away as soon as a Sell signal appears. It also prolongs the trade, which locks up capital. Let's look at some typical cases.

Daily reversal levels as of the close on January 2, 2026

Name		Close	Tr	Mode	RevL (D)	MoM (D)	Days	P/L %	Action	R
Amazon.com Inc	AMZN	226.5	9		**232.23**	1.95 ▼	6	**-2.43%**	Sell	-0.23 ▼ 11

QuickTarget Sell Limit: 227.65
Opportunist Sell Limit: 229.37

AMZN is on a Sell signal. The Close was $226.50, so selling on next Open would probably get us out near that price. AMZN is still in a weak bullish trend (Tr), so we can use the Opportunist exit which means we put in a Sell limit order at $229.37 or better.

If not filled on the first day, then we can adjust our Sell limit order with the new Opportunist price tomorrow and every next day. The risk we take is that the stock may keep sliding lower

without reaching our exit price. So we can also play it a bit more safe by using the QuickTarget, here at $227.65, which is easier to reach.

This a personal decision, which will also depend on whether we want to increase the cash in our account or not.

If market conditions are normal and there was no special news that caused our stock to decline and give a Sell signal, then using the opportunistic exit will often work very well. But if global markets go in panic mode then the first sell is usually the best sell. That's when using a limit sell order can work against us, resulting in a bigger loss to take. Use common sense.

As a final example we have INTU:

Daily reversal levels as of the close on January 2, 2026

Name		Close	Tr	Mode	RevL (D)	MoM (D)	Days	P/L %	Action	R
Intuit Inc	INTU	629.46	19		**671.06**	-0.07 ▼	19	**-5.27%**	Sell	-0.74 ▼ 16

QuickTarget Sell Limit: 637.78
Opportunist Sell Limit: 650.26

INTU is on a Sell signal and showing a 5% loss if you took the preceding Buy signal. This is a stock that is going "double red" and has been in bearish trend for 19 weeks. It also has a negative R value. We can still try to use the Opportunist exit, or use the QuickTarget sell limit to reduce that loss a bit. But when a stock goes double red it is more risky to use this method.

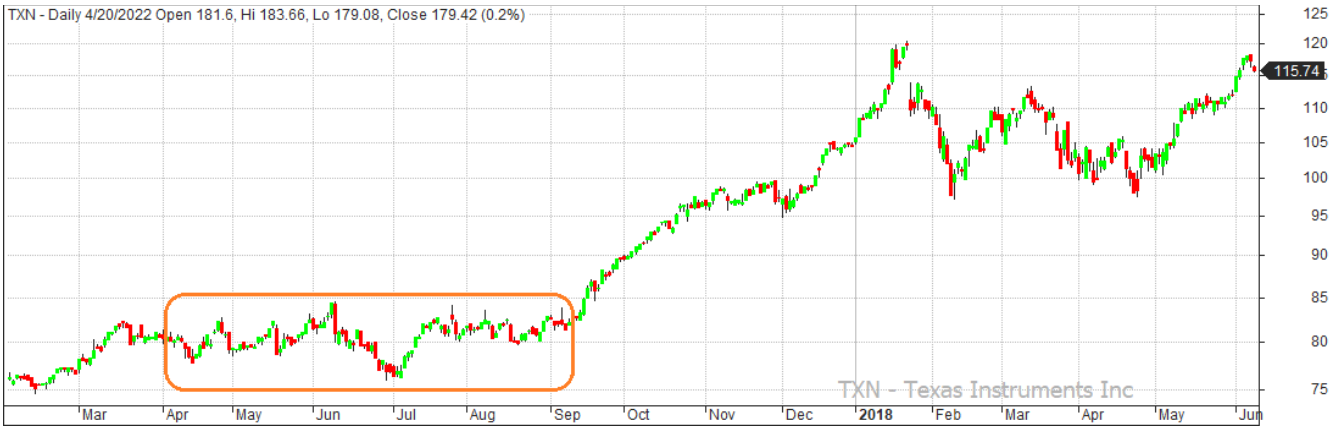
This is an example where the Opportunist Sell can be used to enter a short position (e.g. as a hedge against another stock you own in the same sector). Stocks with negative R value that turn double red are weak. They will often try to rally back to their RevL and fail to get into bullish mode. That's where we can be waiting with an Opportunist Sell limit order to sell short.

Using the Opportunist in choppy markets

Our basic strategy aims to benefit from getting into trending moves and riding them out. But in choppy markets we often don't get good trending moves. We get failed rallies and a series of small losses. That's where this strategy helps us out.

Opportunistic limit buy and sell orders almost always get filled in sideways markets. So we can often trade break-even for a long time until a good trending move does begin, and then we are in for the ride. It gives us staying power in a sideways stocks. Big rallies often start on the heels of long boring choppy periods, so patience is required.

Here is an example of TXN:



This stock started going sideways in March 2017 and went nowhere until September. Trading the normal Buy/Sell signals in this kind of conditions can be frustrating because almost no good rallies develop after a Buy signal. The stock rallies $3 and stops.

With Opportunistic entry we can take more chances as it will limit our loss on those failed rallies. Eventually a bigger rally starts and rewards us. That's what happened in early September here, producing a 50% gain in 6 months. Even the best of stocks go through such sideways pauses. They are easy to spot.

A few notes:

1 - For longer term trading this can also be done solely on the basis of the weekly reversal levels. A weekly level sideways can go on for several years. So, it takes great patience and persistence.

2 - The Opportunist is most effective when our other strategies fail, in sideways choppy conditions. This is generally not the strategy to use in strong trending moves or markets. For example if a stock gives a Buy signal on exciting news (such as strong sales or earnings), then the Opportunist Buy limit will often be left behind as the stock continues higher without looking back.

It is always a judgment call when a stock is on Buy signal. Buy at Open? Or get in cheaper with the Opportunist entry, at the risk of missing out on a big move.

Setting the Opportunist multiplier.

You can set the multipliers in the settings at the top of the html page.

The default for Opportunist muliplier is 0.6, but you can chose a different value, which will also make your limit orders slightly different from other reversal levels traders.

It's standard to set the value for the Opportunist higher than the QuickTarget (default: 0.4).

See also PDF #4 about the Speculative Buy, where the multipliers are explained in more detail.

As always, comments and feedback are welcome. Just reply to any of our daily emails.

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